



The Metal Gear Solid series was associated with PS2

The PS2 and Xbox also cemented an emerging trend among developers to sign up for exclusive deals with console manufacturers; the *Metal Gear Solid* series became a trademark for the PS2 while Xbox relied on the mega-hit Halo as its premier title.

Between the time the PS2 and the Xbox were engaged in their epic battle and waiting to come out with the next generation of consoles, Sony was busy preparing to enter the handheld gaming industry.

The PlayStation Portable was

finally launched in December 2004, just a month after Nintendo launched its DS. The two consoles had gone in completely different directions, as the PSP banked on better graphics and more horsepower to deliver great visuals, while the DS sought to take a more 'fun' approach to gaming.

This philosophical shift would continue into the next generation of video game consoles that the three giants of the industry came out with: the current lot of the Sony PlayStation 3, the Microsoft Xbox 360 and the Nintendo Wii.

For all that you would ever need to know about these three video game consoles, as well as the two current handheld gaming consoles, read on...d



In the last generation of consoles, Sega sang its swan song with the Dreamcast while Sony's PS2 won hearts across the world; meanwhile, Microsoft stepped into the market with the Xbox